DESIGN NOTES

# When the promise and the product disagree

A six-step review for an early-stage team

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# Start with one promise

1. Write the claim a customer sees before signing up.
2. Choose one customer and one task.
3. Keep the exact words in view during the review.

# Walk the first task

1. Open the product as a new customer.
2. Follow the path to the promised result.
3. Note every point that needs an explanation.

# Find a moment that contradicts the claim

1. Compare what was promised with what happens.
2. Separate missing information from missing capability.
3. Record the screen or message that creates the gap.

Hypothetical: easy setup requires an unexplained approval step.

DESIGN NOTES

# Choose the decision that needs attention

1. Should the product change, or should the promise change?
2. Name the constraint behind each option.
3. Avoid starting with a complete visual redesign.

# Test the revised moment

1. Give someone the original customer task.
2. Watch what they expect and what they try.
3. Keep the claim and the product experience together.

# Leave with an owner and a next step

1. Decision: [write the specific choice]
2. Evidence needed: [write what you need to learn]
3. Owner and review date: [write here]